A SHIPPER'S RESOURCE

Cold Chain and Temperature-Sensitive Cargo Import Readiness Checklist

12 things to confirm before you book your next shipment, so the permits, customs treatment and delivery plan are settled early.

Why Late Compliance Costs You in Cold Chain

For cold chain and temperature-sensitive cargo, the cost is rarely the freight. It is a permit, classification or handling requirement discovered after the goods have already shipped. Typical cargo includes frozen food, meat, seafood, dairy, pharmaceuticals, vaccines, biological materials and specialty chemicals. Mills Permits, Mills Customs and Mills Logistics work together to settle these points before you book.

Use this list before you book. Any box you cannot tick is the item to resolve first.

The Readiness Checklist

- [ ] **1. The required temperature range is defined**
  Record the allowed range and any limits on time out of range, from the manufacturer or product specification.

- [ ] **2. Product permits are mapped**
  Confirm which of FDA, BAI, BFAR or NMIS applies, and any other product-specific permit.

- [ ] **3. Agency conditions are understood**
  Check any temperature or handling conditions attached to each permit, and plan for them.

- [ ] **4. Packaging and equipment are chosen**
  Decide between reefer containers, insulated packaging and data loggers, based on the route and the cargo.

- [ ] **5. The carrier and route are confirmed**
  Choose a carrier and route able to hold the temperature range, with limited transfers and waiting.

- [ ] **6. Origin handling is controlled**
  Confirm pre-cooling, loading and sealing at origin, and who records the temperature at departure.

- [ ] **7. Documents include temperature records**
  Make sure shipping documents carry temperature settings and that logger data can be provided on request.

- [ ] **8. Inspection timing is planned**
  Plan customs and agency inspection so the cargo is not left waiting without power or cooling.

- [ ] **9. A qualified cold facility is ready**
  Confirm that cold storage on arrival is qualified for the product, has backup power and is ready to receive.

The Readiness Checklist (continued)

- ☐ **10. Temperature-controlled trucking is arranged**
  Book trucks with working refrigeration, and confirm the temperature will be checked at pickup and delivery.

- ☐ **11. Insurance covers temperature excursions**
  Confirm that cargo insurance addresses temperature failure, with the terms and conditions in writing.

- ☐ **12. An excursion response plan exists**
  Agree who is told and what happens to the cargo if the temperature goes out of range, and keep the records.

Moving cold chain cargo? Let us check it before it ships.

Book a short call and we will review your product, permits and delivery plan before it moves.

BOOK A CALL

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General guidance only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by product and shipment; confirm with The Mills before booking.